

MS battles Adobe

The battle between Silverlight and Flash for dominance is on amid other potential threats like Sun JavaFX

OS X gets Steam

Finally on the 8th of March, Valve officially announced Steam and Source Engine for Apple's OS X. read the full story at <http://bit.ly/9s7azX>

Sparkle GTX 285 2 GB

Double the VRAM double the fun?

The fact that it's based on a high-end GPU means it won't be cheap. And it's not DX11-ready. Against such odds Sparkle thought it prudent to double the VRAM — 2 GB of GDDR3 memory; though the clock speed on the VRAM stays the same — 2.25 GHz. The card has a white heatsink shroud, the plastic of which looks cheaper than the de facto shroud. The heatsink is stock, but we did notice the temperature being around three degrees higher than other GTX 285s we've tested.

We noticed the VRAM playing an ever-so-slight role in boosting fps at higher settings. *Crysis Warhead* for example, showed a drop of just 1 fps when going from a resolution



of 1680 x 1050 to 1920 x 1200 — on other GTX 285s this difference is definitely more pronounced. *Clear Sky* also gives similar scores to *Crysis* — both these games are taxing, and the GTX 285 manages a barely acceptable 26 fps and 23 fps respectively. In *Far Cry 2* we see the GTX 285 barely breaking a sweat and managing 52 fps at a

resolution of 1920 x 1200 with all effects set to maximum. 3D Mark Vantage sees an overall score 14482 — still impressive for a GPU that is nearly two years old. Priced at Rs. 26,000, the Sparkle GTX 285 is nonetheless a retired soldier, and a Radeon HD 5870 will cost the same and perform around 20 per cent better.

Specifications

GPU: GeForce GTX 285,
Stream Processors: 240,
memory: 2 GB, GDDR3,
Core clock: 648 MHz,
Memory clock: 2250 MHz

Contact

Abacus Peripherals Pvt. Ltd

Phone: +91-22-4091 4603

Email: enquiry@abacusperipherals.com

Web site:

www.abacusperipherals.com

Price: 26,000

5.5/10

Features.....7
Performance 6.5
Build quality.....6
Value for money..... 3.5

Specifications

Chipset: Intel P55, Socket 1156, 2x PCIe x16 slots, 2x PCI slots, 1x PCIe x1 slot, 1x PCIe x4 slot, No of SATA ports: 6, No of USB ports: 7

Contact

Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: +91-22-6709 0828

Email:

response@rptechindia.com

Web site:

www.rptechindia.com

Price: Rs. 9,900

6/10

Features.....6
Performance 6.5
Build quality.....6
Value for money.....6

ECS P55H-A Black

Lynnfield gets a (not!) cheap(er) partner!

Adoption of Lynnfield is slow. We blame prices, everyone was immediately interested in outdoing each other and launching better boards, very few offered something good for value-based buyers. This board is well laid out, featuring all solid-state caps. The build quality is mediocre, but the heatsinks with copper inserts that look like a dragons silhouette are pretty neat. The BIOS has cursory overclocking options — there is a manual



mode, but we weren't able to boot when we set our memory timings to 9-9-9-24 @ 1600 MHz, for memory rated at 2000 MHz. Performance was a sore point. Peculiarly, the

scores were all over the place. The WinRAR score of 3745 was the lowest we've seen on this platform, the Cinebench R10 score was also at par with the lower rung of P55 boards. Scores were neck and neck with the ASUS P7P55D Deluxe at most times, below at certain times. Stability was not an option, but we'd like a better heatsink on the chipset that gets hot under load. Priced at Rs. 9,900, the MSI P55-GD65 is a better bet, with a slightly better build and set of components at a lower price.